

HOUSE RESOLUTION 181

By Hill

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Evelyn McQueen Cook
of Mountain City.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Evelyn McQueen Cook of Mountain City; and

WHEREAS, Evelyn Cook was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, a native of Shady Valley, Mrs. Cook was the beloved daughter of Marcus McQueen and Myrtle Gentry McQueen and a seventh-generation member of the McQueen family in Johnson County; and

WHEREAS, Evelyn Cook earned a Bachelor of Arts degree in English from Berea College and a Master of Science degree in Administration and Supervision from the University of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, in her professional career, Mrs. Cook taught English at Johnson County High School for five years; she moved overseas with her husband, who was a superintendent, and taught English for five years at George C. Marshall High School in Ankara, Turkey; and

WHEREAS, Evelyn Cook worked as part of a team with the director of the North Central Accrediting Association for Secondary Schools and Colleges to establish a program that would allow military service personnel to attain a high school diploma instead of a G.E.D.; the program became known as the Pre-discharge Education Program, and Mrs. Cook first served as principal and then as deputy director of the European program; and

WHEREAS, a leader in her community, Mrs. Cook was a member and vice president of the Bristol chapter of Delta Kappa Gamma; charter member of the Mountain City chapter of

Gamma Mu; member and three-time president of the Wednesday Music Club, a local chapter of the Tennessee Federation of Music Clubs; secretary of the Tennessee Federation of Music Clubs, which she served for one term; member of the Democratic Women's Committee of Johnson County; member of the Heritage Hall Board of Directors; chair of the Johnson County branch of the 1986 Tennessee Homecoming; and co-chair of Johnson County's Tennessee 200 committee; and

WHEREAS, she was a strong advocate for the arts and took a particular interest in offering opportunities to young people to perform or enjoy drama and music; she was an avid supporter of the Barter Theatre as a member of the Porterfield Society and the Barter Board of Trustees and an integral part of the Johnson County Center for the Arts, Long Journey Home, and the Junior Appalachian Musicians Program; and

WHEREAS, Evelyn Cook was also deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Cook will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by her daughter, Stephanie L. Cook (Dr. Masaru Okabe); her grandson, Kye L. Okabe; and a host of relatives and friends; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Cook lived a life of service and was a member of First United Methodist Church, where she served in several capacities, including as a Lay Leader, Sunday School teacher, and chair of the Pastor Parish Committee; and

WHEREAS, Evelyn Cook leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the memory of Evelyn McQueen Cook, reflecting fondly upon her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mrs. Cook.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.